AASHAY SALUNKE

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Senior technology consultant with 9+ years of experience in IT Infrastructure services, Digital Transformation and Security Risk Management specializing in the BFSI sector. Proven expertise in hybrid data center modernization, cloud adoption and IT infrastructure standardization, driving resilience, cost optimization and regulatory compliance. Adept at enterprise IT infrastructure architecture & aligning IT roadmaps with business growth and innovation. Skilled in security architecture, governance, risk & compliance with a strong background in risk assessments, audits, and regulatory readiness. Recognized for delivering large-scale infrastructure migrations, disaster recovery programs and multi-vendor solutions ensuring high availability, performance, and business continuity. Accomplished leader with a track record of building and mentoring cross-functional teams, driving initiatives within scope, time & budget and translating technology & strategy into measurable business outcomes.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Seasoned IT Infrastructure and Security Consultant specializing in solution architecture, technology strategy, and hybrid datacenter management within the BFSI sector.
- Expertise in designing and implementing robust IT infrastructure solutions, ensuring high availability, security, and regulatory compliance for financial institutions.
- Proven ability to conduct comprehensive IT infrastructure assessments and audits, identifying risks, gaps, and opportunities for improvement.
- Proficient in managing end-to-end network and security operations, leveraging multi-vendor environments and advanced network security technologies, including Cisco, Juniper, Arista, HP, Dell, Palo Alto, Fortinet, Checkpoint, Citrix, F5.
- Extensive experience in hybrid cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP) and virtualization technologies (VMware ESXi, Hyper-V), facilitating seamless integration and optimal performance.
- Skilled in implementing GRC frameworks (ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework, PCI-DSS) and ensuring adherence to regulatory requirements.
- Successfully led data center migrations, disaster recovery initiatives, and network optimization projects, minimizing disruptions and maximizing efficiency.
- Certified in PMP, TOGAF, Cisco, Fortinet, CompTIA Security, Microsoft, ITIL v4,ISO 27001:2022, CISA, Azure and AWS, demonstrating commitment to professional development and industry best practices.

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Network Security, Switching, Routing, Firewall Management, Load Balancing, Cloud Computing (Azure, AWS), Virtualization, Operating Systems (Windows, Linux), ISO 27001, NIST Framework, Vulnerability Management

Soft Skills: Leadership Planning, Stakeholder Engagement, Problem Solving, Conflict Resolution, Team Mentoring

Core Competencies: Strategic Planning, Program & Portfolio Management, Network Security Architect, FinOps, Capacity Planning, Commercial & Technical Evaluation, Audits, Business Continuity, Risk Mitigation, IT Governance, IT Infrastructure Management, Root Cause Analysis, Incident Management, Vendor Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ernst & Young

Senior Consultant - Cloud & IT Infrastructure Services (Feb 2025 - Sep 2025)

Provided expert IT consulting services to BFSI clients, ensuring alignment with industry best practices and regulatory requirements. Assessed current infrastructure, designed future-state solutions, and provided support throughout the implementation process.

- Conducted comprehensive IT infrastructure assessments and audits for BFSI clients, focusing on network security and regulatory compliance.
- Designed scalable hybrid connectivity solutions, integrating on-premises systems with AWS and Azure to enhance business agility.
- Delivered RCA-driven issue resolution, ensuring minimal disruption and improved operational efficiency.
- Established standardization frameworks and best practices to improve IT governance and streamline processes.
- Contributed to RFPs and solution workshops, providing technical expertise and strategic guidance.

Achievements:

- Identified critical gaps in network infrastructure, leading to the implementation of robust security measures and improved compliance.
- Developed and implemented innovative hybrid connectivity solutions, enabling seamless integration between on-premises systems and cloud environments.
- Improved overall IT resilience and reduced potential downtime through RCA-driven problem-solving and preventative measures.

Omnenest

Network Engineer (Role Expansion: Implementation Manager Responsibilities) (Mar 2024 - Jan 2025)

Oversaw operational aspects of all client network service delivery, ensuring compliance, availability, and performance for all client systems.

- Managed managed services operations for the NEST trading platform, supporting 20+ brokers with high uptime, low-latency, and regulatory compliance.
- Acted as SPOC for key accounts Zerodha and Groww, collaborating with business teams to develop pricing models to optimize revenue.
- Managed end-to-end IT infrastructure lifecycle across compute, network, and security, achieving >99.9% uptime through capacity planning, failover testing, BCP/DR drills, and RCA-driven preventive measures.

- Spearheaded data center migrations and disaster recovery initiatives, leading a 20+ member cross-functional team to ensure operations were scalable, resilient, and growth-ready.

Achievements:
- Conducted a cost-benefit analysis (CBA) of production assets, evaluating obsolescence and driving selection of the right technology and OEM products, optimizing refresh cycles and reducing costs by 20%.
- Architected and implemented dedicated trading infrastructure environment for GROWW, improved operations, performance, security, SLAs, and enabled SEBI-compliant operations, resulted in a 1.6x increase in revenue.
- Led migration of 40+ racks during DC decommissioning (Vikhroli NTT DC-2), coordinated OEMs and system integrators with zero business disruption.

Bandwidth Infinity
Manager (Mar 2023 - Feb 2024)

Managed ISP network operations, focusing on proactive maintenance, capacity planning, and performance optimization. Led engineering team and managed enterprise client communication ensuring SLA compliance.

- Oversaw end-to-end ISP network operations across Fiber and Wireless systems, ensuring high availability and seamless connectivity.
- Directed a 6-member engineering team, providing leadership and technical guidance.
- Managed enterprise client relationships, ensuring SLA compliance, incident resolution, and customer satisfaction.

Achievements:
- Implemented proactive maintenance strategies, optimizing network performance and reducing potential downtime.
- Enhanced network capacity planning, ensuring scalable infrastructure to support growing business needs.
- Improved customer satisfaction through reliable service delivery and effective incident resolution.

LTIMindtree | Nets A/S (On-site Copenhagen, Denmark)
Specialist - Cloud & IT Infrastructure Services (Jan 2022 - Mar 2023)

Oversaw key cloud and infrastructure service planning, execution, and monitoring, while providing comprehensive support in pre-sales and governance activities.

- Planned, executed, and monitored IT infrastructure initiatives, ensuring SLA compliance and structured change management.
- Managed lifecycle tasks for IT infrastructure, maintaining strict scope, schedule, and quality controls.
- Actively participated in Scrum cadences and CAB meetings, driving risk assessment and change evaluation.
- Supported pre-sales activities through RFP responses, BOM preparation, and effort estimation, while maintaining project documentation.

Achievements:
- Created a Plan of Action (PoA) for Network Expansion & Optimization aligning sequencing, dependencies, and resources with Work Breakdown Structure (WBS).
- Addressed critical issue, decreased ticket volume by 30% and authored Post-Incident Reports (PIR) to drive root-cause analysis and implement preventive measures.
- Demonstrated meticulous monitoring and lifecycle management of client IT infrastructure.

NTT Global Data Centers & Cloud Infrastructure India
Senior Network Security Engineer - Hybrid NOC (Sep 2019 - Jan 2022)

Oversaw network and security operations for multiple enterprise clients. Managed network and security devices, ensured adherence to compliance, and supported security operations.

- Directed end-to-end network and security operations for 15+ enterprise clients across NTT India Data Centers, administering multi-vendor environments.
- Configured and optimized TCP/IP and security protocols, load balancers, and security systems to ensure high availability and performance.
- Secured hybrid environments by configuring firewalls and implementing UTM features, including WAF, IPS/IDS, and DDoS mitigation.
- Strengthened cybersecurity posture by leveraging SIEM tools for threat detection and response, executing SOC functions.
- Implemented GRC frameworks in alignment with ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework, and PCI-DSS.

Achievements:
- PAYBACK Group – Disaster Recovery Architecture: Designed and implemented DC–DR network architecture to ensure business continuity, high availability, and regulatory compliance, strengthening enterprise resilience.
- HDFC Life – Firewall Modernization: Led migration from Check Point R77 to R80 with centralized management, enhancing security governance, policy control, and operational efficiency.
- Hungama – Application Delivery Optimization: Optimized Citrix NetScaler policies to improve application performance, availability, and end-user experience across high-traffic environments.
- SITI – SD-WAN Enablement: Enabled Fortinet SD-WAN to optimize DC-DR connectivity, improving link performance, resiliency, and cost efficiency through intelligent traffic steering.
- NSE Data & Analytics – Vulnerability & Resilience Strengthening: Implemented Nessus vulnerability management and Business Continuity Management (BCM) controls to enhance security posture, resilience, and risk visibility.
- Risk Assessment & Compliance: Conducted NIST-based risk assessments to identify, prioritize, and remediate vulnerabilities, supporting regulatory compliance and continuous security improvement.
- Religare Broking – Routing & SD-WAN Modernization: Led enhancement of dual-homed BGP, multicast, and enterprise routing architecture; supported VMware Velocloud SD-WAN integration to improve resiliency, link utilization, and application performance in a regulated BFSI environment.
- Dish TV & SITI – M&A Network Integration: Executed post-merger network integration, consolidating multi-site infrastructure and ensuring seamless connectivity, minimal service disruption, and operational continuity across merged entities.
- YES Asset – Secure Office Connectivity: Designed and implemented secure enterprise network connectivity for new office locations, integrating branch infrastructure with centralized systems while enforcing security, access controls, and compliance standards.
- Security Operations & Risk Management: Directed security operations by identifying and mitigating IOC/CVE threats, conducting NIST-based risk assessments, and implementing preventive and detective controls. Strengthened security posture through continuous monitoring, access policy enforcement, and SIEM-driven threat detection and response.

- Audit & Compliance Governance: Participated in enterprise-wide infrastructure audits covering security, regulatory compliance, performance, configuration, and BCP/DR readiness, contributing to risk remediation plans and improved audit outcomes.

Future Focus Infotech | IBM - CRISIL

Network Engineer (Aug 2018 - Jul 2019)

Managed global network infrastructure and security, enforced security policies, and conducted assessments for CRISIL.

- Managed global LAN/WAN networks across CRISIL DC/DR sites and branches, supporting multi-vendor infrastructure.
- Designed and enforced multi-layered security policies across NGFW, IPS/IDS, WAF, and VPNs.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments, resilience testing, and BCP/DR drills.
- Maintained detailed documentation, including implementation plans and audit compliance reports.

Achievements:

- Migrated Cisco ASA to Fortinet FortiGate firewalls, enhancing throughput, threat prevention, and compliance.
- Transitioned from on-prem Forcepoint to Symantec WSS Cloud, improving scalability and SSL inspection.
- Replaced legacy Juniper and Cisco switches with Extreme & Arista switches, boosting performance and port density.

CERTIFICATIONS

- ITIL v4 Foundation (AXELOS - GR671652001AS)
- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor (GAQM - G-106148)
- Cisco Certified Specialist - Data Center Core (CSCO1498896)
- CompTIA Security+ (COMP00102254921)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (A3C327D1A05)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate (5a42a53f7d17421ca240ec18c12ba5b)
- Fortinet Certified Associate in Cybersecurity (4072977260A)
- Project Management Professional (PMP) (PMI - 377834)
- Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA) (ISACA - 174215)
- TOGAF Enterprise Architecture Practitioner (The Open Group - 19349)
- Agile Scrum Foundation (SimpliLearn)
- AWS Partner: Sales Accreditation
- AWS Partner: Cloud Economics Accreditation

EDUCATION

Rabindranath Tagore University
Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)

Maharashtra State Board of Technical Education
Diploma in Computer Engineering (Industry Integrated)

HOBBIES

Tech Innovation, Cybersecurity Research, Cloud Computing, Financial News